

Whose Account Is This?

books-101 — the first slice of the Plaid rebuild

You told me it is just you and Alyssa, that you each keep your own accounts and your own connection, and why. You also said you want one set of books your grandfather can use to do the returns, and that the Citi Mastercard "stays with me always and is only used for greenway marijuana purchases." I built the piece all of that depends on.

The problem, in one sentence

Nothing on a connected account said whose it was, so the books guessed from the shop name — and an Amazon order was an Amazon order whether you bought bags for the store or Alyssa bought something for the house. Both landed in Greenway. A personal charge sitting in Greenway's expenses is a deduction on a cannabis return that should not be there, and it is the kind of thing an examiner finds quickly. The entry balanced, the bank reconciled, nothing looked wrong. That is defect 80.

What each account now carries

Three separate labels, because they answer three different questions and they genuinely disagree with each other. **Owner** is whose account it is, you or Alyssa — for net worth and for knowing who to ask; it deliberately does not affect where money lands. **Books** is which set the activity belongs to — Greenway, ATM, Land holding, or Personal — and this one decides the numbers. **Role** is which account on the chart it stands for, unchanged from before.

Your Citi Mastercard is the case that proves one label could never have done the job: Owner is you, Books is Greenway, Role is credit card. It is your personal card and every dollar on it is the shop's. One field cannot say that without lying about something.

What happens now

The books ask the account, not the shop name. A charge on an account set to Personal is tracked for your net worth and your spending and kept out of the business ledgers entirely — as a decision, not an error, so you never see a warning tempting you to mislabel a personal card just to make it go away.

An account nobody has classified yet keeps downloading transactions and balances and posts nothing at all. I chose that over defaulting to Greenway, because defaulting would quietly do the exact thing this slice exists to stop, to accounts you had not even looked at. Fixing an unclassified account takes ten seconds; finding a personal charge buried in a filed return does not.

There is a second fix in here. You could not have tagged the Citi card even if you had wanted to: the system allowed exactly one account per role, so the second credit card was refused and the only way in was to untag the first, which would have silently stopped that card posting. That is defect 79. Cards, savings, mortgages and loans now repeat freely. Only "Main operating" stays unique, for a real reason — vendor and payroll reconciliation both sweep every account holding it, so a second one would start pulling your groceries into payroll matching.

What I did not do, and what I need

I did not add a **joint** owner. You said you will have joint accounts "at some point when it's allowed," and I would rather add it the day it is real than leave a half-considered option sitting in the list. It is one line when you want it. I did not backfill your existing accounts either: there is no record of whose they are, and that absence is the whole defect, so guessing would be inventing the answer this slice exists to stop inventing. The connection management screen and the multi-connection linking flow from the audit sit on top of this, and this had to be solid first.

To prove it is, I made twenty-one deliberate breaks — treating a blank tag as "assume business," letting the owner decide the books and pushing your Citi card into the personal pile, folding "personal" into an error, dropping the column from the query so the check runs on nothing. All twenty-one were caught. Three survived my first attempt, which is why the exercise is worth doing: my tests were checking the decision without checking that the decision was ever reached. Full suite: 12,924 tests across 507 files, all green.

So: open the Plaid screen and set Owner and Books on each connected account. The Citi Mastercard is Michael / Greenway. Your business checking is Michael / Greenway. Anything of Alyssa's is Alyssa / Personal. Nothing posts until you do, so there is no rush and no risk in taking your time. Once they are set, tell me and I will build the connection-management screen so you can add the rest — her cards, the portfolios, the debt — and see how many of the twenty free connections you have left.